

Navigate to the QoS tab. It can be found under any of these tabs in the menu: 'Advanced Setup', 'NAT/QoS' or 'Quality of Service' tabs. Select QoS > "Enable QoS" > Click **Save/Apply**. In case you see 'default DSCP mark', 'Queueing Discipline' and 'Packet Scheduler' under the options, just leave them at default.

EFFECTIVELY SETTING CONNECTION VALUES

You will see text fields for "Downlink" and "Uplink" values within the QoS settings. It is advised to enter slightly reduced values for both the fields. This is done because QoS rules work by creating an artificial bottleneck such that the traffic passes as per the rules for QoS to work effectively. Do this – Refer your speed-test results > Multiply both the values by 0.8 to get a reduced speed value (80% of available speed) > enter the value > Click **Save/Apply**.

PRIORITIZING YOUR NETWORK TRAFFIC

Prioritising traffic is the crux of QoS and most of it is done by setting prioritisation rules for everything under the sun. If you belong to the lucky set of people who have a router with easy QoS options, setting network priority is child's play. Most of these tweaks can be done by performing drag-and-drop operations on a list of services. The most important services that you want to prioritise go to the top of the list, while those with the least importance in terms of network utilisation go to the bottom.

Many router configuration settings now provide sliders

for setting priority. They allow you to set a percentage for your traffic under High, Middle or Low Priority. General rule of thumb is to allot: 60% of bandwidth for High Priority, 30% for Middle priority and 10% for Low priority. Setting these values determines the quantity of bandwidth allocated to a particular service or application that you will set under the QoS priority rules.

Make sure to be very critical while allotting bandwidth as the success of this ordeal will depend largely on this.

SERVICE AND APPLICATION PRIORITY

Setting a network-wide application/service priority rule, such that every device connected to your network follows that priority when accessing said application/service, is also possible under QoS. You can set priority by application in the sense that if, for instance, you have an FTP server setup and you want to allocate the highest priority for it then you should add FTP to the list of QoS rules along with other applications that are important in your use case. There might be a possibility where you don't see a particular application/service listed under the rules, in that case you can always select the 'Custom Application' option



QoS Rules for Priority By Application

and manually add application details to add it to the priority list. Once you are done adding rules, Hit **Save/Apply** to save your changes and you should see your rules listed under the priority tables as per their order.

SETTING PRIORITY FOR CONNECTED DEVICES

There might be instances where, although you have set QoS priorities for individual applications for everyone who accesses the network, you might still decide to have a more fine-grained control over the connected devices in your network as well. This can be achieved by setting device priority using the device's IP address. To do that, go to the **QoS** tab > add new rule under the priority level that you want the device to have > QoS rule type should be 'By Device' > Enter the name of the device or find it from the list of existing connected devices > Select the device by identifying it through its Name or IP address > The selected device(s) should now be a part of the QoS rule list.

This way, you can ensure that none of the devices in your wired/wireless network fall out of line in terms of bandwidth consumption while also following the application/service priority that we set initially. Finally, you can also tweak priority levels such that wired connections have priority over wireless connections or vice versa under 'Interface Priority' for even better control over it.

QOS FOR GAMING:

More than half the battle is already won in terms of a QoS setup if you possess an expensive and powerful router that is primed for gaming. The ASUS ROG Rapture GT-AC5300 is an example for one such router that we have tested here. For setting up QoS with gaming at the centre of your use case, you can decide on a priority list that is similar to this:

Priority Level	Type of Traffic
Highest	Gaming
High	Real-time audio (VoIP)
Normal	General web traffic
Low	Torrents

Many of these high-end routers feature adaptive QoS and even options for connecting directly to certain game server regions and if your router is one of them, you should definitely enable them to take advantage of those settings.

DON'T OVERDO IT

Like all things in life, you should be critical in balancing your QoS rules such that they are minimal and quite selective. Meaning, you should not try and create 20 rules outright. Having an unnecessary number of QoS rules can introduce more issues than solve the ones you had previously. The best way to go about setting rules is by weighing in your individual use case and address it by creating rules only for the most important network issues you have. Another idea is to actually check the network step-by-step after every incremental change to the QoS rules so that you know what went wrong in case something did go wrong.